AI SEO Masterclass

0%

THE MONSTER AI SEO / LLM S...

TABLE OF CONTENTS

INTRODUCTION: WHY AI SEO I...

MODULE 1: TRADITIONAL SEO ...

MODULE 2: AI SEO / GEO COM...

MODULE 3: CHATGPT RANKIN...

MODULE 4: LLM CITATIONS - T...

MODULE 5: LOCAL SEO IN THE ...

MODULE 6: PARASITE SEO - STI...

MODULE 7: REDDIT & SOCIAL S...

MODULE 8: CONTENT STRATE...

MODULE 9: TOOLS, TECH STAC...

MODULE 10: REAL CASE STUDI...

BONUS: SOPS, TEMPLATES, AN...

FINAL THOUGHTS

APPENDIX: ADDITIONAL RESO...

MODULE 9: TOOLS, TECH STACK, AND IMPLEMENTATION

REPEAT AFTER ME:

You can't optimize what you're not tracking. And you can't scale what you haven't systematized. Tools matter — but only if you use the right ones, the right way.

Most people buy 15 tools and use 3 of them. I'm going to tell you exactly which tools I actually open every single day, which ones sit there collecting dust, and which ones made me money versus which ones just made my credit card statement longer.

I've tested over 40 SEO and AI tools in the last 18 months. Here's the truth nobody selling you tool roundups will tell you: 80% of your results come from 4-5 tools max. Everything else is a distraction dressed up as productivity.

🎯 Learning Objectives

By the end of this module, you will:

- Know the exact tools I use daily to run a $3.4M/year SEO operation
- Build a minimum viable tech stack for under $200/month
- Understand when to upgrade and what's worth paying for
- Set up automation workflows that save 10-15 hours per week
- Configure WordPress specifically for AI SEO performance

9.1 The Tool Stack That Actually Makes Money

Let me save you a year of testing. Here's what I use, what I pay, and what each tool actually does for my bottom line.

Tier 1: Non-Negotiable (Use These or You're Flying Blind)

These are the tools I would keep if I could only pick five. Everything else is a bonus.

Ahrefs ($99-999/mo) — This is the backbone of every keyword decision I make. I use it for keyword research, backlink analysis, competitor gap analysis, and content audits. The Site Explorer alone is worth the subscription. If you're doing any kind of SEO — traditional, AI, local, parasite — you need backlink data and keyword volume data. Ahrefs gives you both better than anyone else. I'm on the $399/mo plan because I need the API access and higher limits for running audits across my portfolio of sites. If you're just starting, the $99 Lite plan is fine. You'll outgrow it in 3-4 months if you're serious.

LocalRank.so ($47.50-1,664/mo) — Yes, I built this. Yes, I'm biased. But I built it because nothing else did what I needed. LocalRank handles local rank tracking with heatmap-based Google Maps monitoring, 500+ instant citations with one click, LLM citation building across our 500+ domain network, Direction Boost with real drivers, a local leads database with 15M+ verified contacts, and GBP AI Autopilot for automated posting and review management. The Pro plan at $247.50/mo (annual) is the sweet spot for most agencies. You get enough credits for 5-10 clients and access to every feature. If you're running a local SEO agency without this, you're doing 10x the work for the same results.

Trackings.ai (Included with LocalRank Scale+) — This is the only tool that tracks LLM citations across ChatGPT, Google AI

when competitors get mentioned, and when citation positions change. If you're doing AI SEO without tracking AI citations, you're guessing. And guessing doesn't scale.

ChatGPT Plus ($20/mo) — I use GPT-4o for content generation, research, topic ideation, and running the AI content prompts from Module 8. The web browsing capability is crucial — it lets you verify facts and pull current data into your content. Twenty dollars a month for a tool that replaces $2,000/mo worth of content writers. No-brainer.

Google Search Console (Free) — If you're not checking Search Console weekly, you're leaving money on the table. I use it to monitor indexing status, find keyword opportunities from impression data, identify technical issues, and track which pages get AI Overview traffic. The Performance report filtered by "Search Appearance" now shows AI Overview clicks separately. Set this up on day one. No excuses.

Tier 2: Worth Paying For (Use When You're Past $5K/Mo)

Claude Pro ($20/mo) — I use Claude as my second opinion. When ChatGPT gives me content that feels generic, I run the same prompt through Claude and usually get something with more nuance. Claude's longer context window is also better for analyzing large datasets or rewriting entire pages. Having both ChatGPT and Claude means you're never stuck with one AI's limitations.

SurferSEO ($89-219/mo) — Surfer's content editor gives you a target score based on what's ranking. I use it for traditional SEO content, not for AI-optimized content (different optimization targets). The SERP Analyzer is useful for understanding what Google wants for specific queries. Worth it once you're publishing 10+ pieces per month.



Their site audit tool is also decent for catching technical issues.

Screaming Frog ($259/year) — The best technical SEO audit tool, period. I run crawls monthly on all my sites. It catches broken links, duplicate content, missing schema, redirect chains, and about 200 other things that hurt your rankings. The free version crawls up to 500 URLs, which is enough for smaller sites.

Tier 3: Nice to Have (Don't Buy Until You Need Them)

Semrush ($119-449/mo) — Overlaps heavily with Ahrefs. I keep a subscription for their advertising data and the Keyword Magic Tool, but if you have Ahrefs, you don't need Semrush until you're doing PPC or need their specific competitive intelligence features.

Pitchbox ($195-595/mo) — Outreach automation for link building at scale. Only worth it if you're sending 100+ outreach emails per week. Below that volume, do it manually or use Instantly.

Koala AI ($9-49/mo) — Built specifically for SEO content. I use it for bulk content generation when I need 20-30 articles fast. Quality is good enough for PBN content and supporting pages. Not good enough for money pages without heavy editing.

Clearscope ($170-1,200/mo) — Premium content optimization. Better than SurferSEO in some ways, but 2x the price. Only worth it for enterprise teams or if you're obsessive about content scoring.

💡 **Pro Tip:** Don't buy tools you won't use daily. Start with Tier 1, add Tier 2 when you hit $5K/mo revenue, and only touch Tier 3



opened again.

9.2 The LocalRank.so Complete System (Deep Dive)

Since LocalRank is the centerpiece of my local SEO and AI SEO workflow, let me break down exactly how I use each feature and what it does for revenue.

Local Rank Tracker — This isn't your typical "check position for keyword" tracker. LocalRank uses heatmap-based tracking that shows you exactly where in your service area you rank on Google Maps. You'll see a grid overlaid on a map — green where you're top 3, yellow where you're 4-10, red where you're invisible. This is how you find geographic weak spots and know exactly where to focus Direction Boost credits. I run scans weekly for every client. The automated scheduled scans mean I don't have to remember — it just emails me the reports.

Citations Builder (500+ Instant Citations) — The old way: spend 40 hours manually submitting to directories, wait weeks, fix inconsistencies. The LocalRank way: enter your NAP once, click submit, get 500+ citations across verified directories within 24-48 hours. Bulk edit if anything changes. Bulk delete if you close a location. This single feature saves my agency 30+ hours per client onboarding. At $50/hour VA rates, that's $1,500 in labor savings per client.

LLM Citations — This is the feature that took LocalRank from "nice local SEO tool" to "$50K MRR." We generate AI-written listicles (1,000+ words each) with your business positioned #1, publish them across our 500+ domain network, and get them indexed in 2-4 hours. Within 24-48 hours, ChatGPT starts citing these pages. Within 7-14 days, you're showing up in AI search results for your target keywords. No other tool does this at this scale.

sees genuine user behavior signals and your rankings improve within 7 days. This works in the US, Canada, UK, and Australia. We guarantee positive movement for keywords already in the top 20. Average result: top 20 → top 3 within 2 weeks.

Local Leads Database — 15M+ verified business contacts with advanced filtering by industry, location, revenue, employee count, and more. I use this to find leads for cold email campaigns. Pull 1,000 leads in your target niche, export to CSV, load into Instantly, and start sending. Credits-based so you only pay for what you use.

GBP AI Autopilot — Connects to your Google Business Profile and handles automated posting (weekly posts generated by AI), review monitoring with smart response suggestions, performance analytics, and multi-location management. The Review Booster feature sends automated review requests to customers via email and SMS. I've seen clients go from 15 reviews to 100+ in 60 days using this alone.

Pricing breakdown:

- Starter: $47.50/mo (annual) — Perfect for single-location businesses
- Pro: $247.50/mo (annual) — Sweet spot for agencies with 5-10 clients ⭐
- Scale: $372.50/mo (annual) — Includes Trackings.ai for LLM monitoring
- Enterprise: $1,664.17/mo (annual) — White-label, API access, unlimited everything

---

9.3 The Complete Tech Stack at Every Budget Level



Ahrefs Lite

Cost: $99 / month
Purpose: Keyword research, backlink analysis

LocalRank Starter

Cost: $47.50 / month
Purpose: Rank tracking, citation management

ChatGPT Plus

Cost: $20 / month
Purpose: Content creation

Google Workspace

Cost: $6 / month
Purpose: Email, documents, storage

Buffer (Free → $15 / month)

Cost: $15 / month
Purpose: Social media scheduling

Google Search Console

Cost: Free
Purpose: Technical monitoring

Google Analytics 4

Cost: Free
Purpose: Traffic analysis



This stack handles keyword research, content creation, rank tracking, citation building, social distribution, and analytics. You can run a profitable agency or content business on this alone.

The $497/Mo Stack (Scaling to $10K+/Mo)

Ahrefs Standard

Cost: $199 / month
Purpose: Full keyword research + backlink suite

LocalRank Pro

Cost: $247.50 / month
Purpose: Full agency-level features

ChatGPT Plus

Cost: $20 / month
Purpose: Content generation

Claude Pro

Cost: $20 / month
Purpose: Alternative AI, long-form content

Instantly

Cost: $30 / month
Purpose: Cold email outreach

Google Workspace

Cost: $6 / month
Purpose: Business email



The $1,200/Mo Stack (Running a $50K+/Mo Operation)

Ahrefs Advanced

Cost: $399 / month
Purpose: API access, higher crawl & report limits

LocalRank Scale

Cost: $372.50 / month
Purpose: Full-scale tracking + Trackings.ai included

SurferSEO

Cost: $89 / month
Purpose: Content optimization

ChatGPT Plus

Cost: $20 / month
Purpose: Content creation

Claude Pro

Cost: $20 / month
Purpose: Research + editing

SE Ranking

Cost: $79 / month
Purpose: Traditional rank tracking

Screaming Frog

Instantly

Cost: $77 / month
Purpose: Scale cold email outreach

Zapier

Cost: $49 / month
Purpose: Automation

Google Workspace

Cost: $6 / month
Purpose: Business suite

Total Monthly Cost

$1,133.08 / month

💡 **Pro Tip:** Your tool stack should never exceed 10% of your monthly revenue. If you're making $2K/mo, spend $200/mo on tools max. Upgrade as revenue grows, not before.

9.4 WordPress Setup for AI SEO

WordPress powers 43% of the web, and for good reason — it's the most flexible CMS for SEO. Here's exactly how I configure every new WordPress site for maximum AI visibility.

Theme: GeneratePress ($59/year). Lightweight, fast, clean code. Don't use heavy themes like Divi or Avada — they add 2-3 seconds of load time and output messy HTML that LLMs struggle to parse. GeneratePress loads in under 1 second and outputs clean, semantic HTML.



tags, schema markup, sitemaps, redirects, and on-page analysis. I prefer it over Yoast for the built-in schema generator and the content AI features. Set it up once, and it handles 80% of your on-page SEO automatically.

- **WP Rocket ($49/year)** — Caching and performance. Enables page caching, browser caching, GZIP compression, lazy loading, and minification. This alone cuts load time by 40-60%. Don't use free caching plugins — they break things. WP Rocket just works.
- **Schema Pro ($79/year)** — Advanced schema markup beyond what Rank Math provides. I use this for Product schema, LocalBusiness schema, and custom schema types. Generates valid JSON-LD that AI models can parse.
- **ShortPixel ($4.99/mo)** — Image optimization. Compresses images on upload without visible quality loss. Smaller images = faster pages = better Core Web Vitals = better rankings.
- **Table of Contents Plus (Free)** — Automatically generates a clickable table of contents for long-form content. AI models use these as structural signals. Also improves user experience and time-on-page.
- **TablePress (Free)** — Creates comparison tables that render as proper HTML tables. AI models love structured tabular data. Every "Best X" listicle should have a comparison table.
- **Instant Indexing (Free)** — Uses the Google Indexing API to get pages indexed within minutes instead of days. Essential for freshness-dependent AI SEO content

Configuration checklist:

1. Set permalinks to /%postname%/
2. Enable breadcrumbs in Rank Math
3. Set up XML sitemap (Rank Math)

5. Add FAQ schema to every listicle
6. Enable Article schema on all blog posts
7. Set Cloudflare as CDN (free plan)
8. Test with PageSpeed Insights — target 90+ on mobile

Critical robots.txt addition for AI SEO:

> User-agent: GPTBot
>
> Allow: /
>
> User-agent: ClaudeBot
>
> Allow: /
>
> User-agent: PerplexityBot
>
> Allow: /
>
> User-agent: Google-Extended
>
> Allow: /

Most sites block AI crawlers by default. You WANT them crawling your content. This is the entire point of AI SEO. Make sure your robots.txt allows every major LLM crawler.

9.5 Automation & Workflow Systems

Here's how I save 10-15 hours per week with automation:

Content Pipeline Automation: I use Zapier to connect ChatGPT → Google Docs → WordPress. When I create a content brief in a Google Sheet, Zapier triggers ChatGPT to generate a draft, saves it to Google Docs for human editing, and after approval, publishes it to WordPress with proper formatting. Total setup time: 2 hours. Time saved per week: 5+ hours.

by an LLM. I also have Ahrefs alerts for new backlinks and lost backlinks. Google Search Console sends weekly email summaries. All of this runs without me touching anything.

Client Reporting Automation: LocalRank generates white-label reports automatically. I set up scheduled reports for every client — weekly rank tracking emails and monthly comprehensive reports. Clients get professional PDFs with their logo, ranking changes, citation counts, and review growth. Takes zero ongoing effort after initial setup.

Social Distribution Automation: When a new post goes live on WordPress, Zapier shares it to Buffer, which schedules it across Twitter, LinkedIn, and Facebook. A separate Zap creates a Medium draft for syndication. Another creates a LinkedIn article draft. I review and publish the syndicated versions with minor tweaks — but the drafts are created automatically.

Tools for automation:

- Zapier ($19-599/mo) — Most integrations, easiest to use
- Make/Integromat ($9-29/mo) — Cheaper, more complex workflows
- n8n (Free, self-hosted) — For developers who want full control
- Custom Python scripts — For anything the tools can't do

💡 **Pro Tip:** Automate reporting and distribution first. Those are the biggest time sinks with the least creative input required. Save your brain power for strategy and content quality — automate everything else.

9.6 Implementation Timeline

Week 1: Foundation



- Day 3: Install WordPress + essential plugins
- Day 4: Configure schema markup + robots.txt
- Day 5: Set up Trackings.ai monitoring
- Day 6: Create content templates in Google Docs
- Day 7: Test entire workflow end-to-end

Week 2: Content System

- Create your content calendar (plan 30 days)
- Set up ChatGPT custom GPT with your brand guidelines
- Build 5 content templates (listicle, comparison, how-to, research, review)
- Create your first 3 pieces of AI-optimized content
- Set up distribution channels (social profiles, Medium, LinkedIn)

Week 3: Automation

- Set up Zapier workflows (content pipeline + distribution)
- Configure automated reporting for any clients
- Set up monitoring alerts (Trackings.ai + Ahrefs)
- Create your weekly task checklist
- Test all automations

Week 4: Launch & Monitor

- Publish first batch of content
- Submit all pages for indexing
- Test in ChatGPT within 48 hours

📋 Action Items

1. Sign up for your Tier 1 tools today (Ahrefs, LocalRank, ChatGPT Plus, Google Search Console)
2. Install WordPress with the exact plugin stack listed above
3. Update your robots.txt to allow all AI crawlers
4. Set up at least one Zapier automation this week
5. Create your content calendar for the next 30 days
6. Configure Trackings.ai to monitor your brand and top 3 competitors

🔑 Key Takeaways

- **Start with 4-5 tools max.** Tier 1 is all you need to make money. Add more as revenue justifies the cost.
- **LocalRank + Trackings.ai is the AI SEO command center.** Track everything — traditional rankings, local maps, and LLM citations — in one place.
- **Allow AI crawlers in robots.txt.** This is the #1 technical mistake I see. If you're blocking GPTBot, you're invisible to ChatGPT.
- **Automate reporting and distribution.** Save your human hours for strategy and content quality.
- **Your tool budget should be under 10% of revenue.** If a tool isn't directly making you money, cancel it.